LESSON PACK · WEEK 2 · LESSON 3 · ACCIDENTS AND EMERGENCIES

Suddenly, ...

Grammar · Past Continuous vs Past Simple: when / while

Words · Everyday incidents



BY THE END YOU CAN SAY

I was crossing the street when a car stopped.

While we were waiting, it started to rain.

WARM-UP · ELEMENTARY IS STILL ALIVE

Let's talk first

1. Elementary: Which is bigger, a village or a city? What is the most interesting place in your country?

   Elementary: Что больше, деревня или город? Какое самое интересное место в вашей стране?

2. Tell me about a funny or embarrassing thing that happened to you. What did you do?

   Расскажи о смешном или неловком случае с тобой. Что ты сделал?

DID YOU KNOW?

In stories the background is in the past continuous and the events are in the past simple.

В рассказах фон передаётся в past continuous, а события — в past simple.

CORE WORDS 1 / 2

Today's 20 words

D
drop
уронить

B
bump
удариться

S
spill
пролить

K
knock
стучать

S
smash
разбить


ring
звонить

C
crack
треснуть

H
honk
сигналить

S
scratch
поцарапать

W
wave
махать

CORE WORDS 2 / 2

Today's 20 words

C **chase** — гнаться

R **recognize** — узнать

R **rush** — спешить, мчаться

P **pretend** — притворяться

H **hurry** — торопиться

A **apologize** — извиняться

I **ignore** — игнорировать

E **embarrassing** — неловкий

R **realize** — осознать

U **unlucky** — невезучий

EXTRA WORDS 1 / 2 · ONLY IF YOU WANT MORE

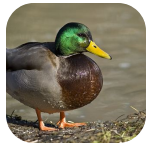
20 extra words, easy to use

S **stumble**
споткнуться

T **tumble**
кувыркнуться, упасть

G **grab**
схватить

S **snatch**
выхватить



duck
пригнуться

D **dodge**
увернуться

S **swerve**
свернуть в сторону

C **clatter**
греметь, грохотать

S **skid**
занести (на дороге)

S **stall**
заглохнуть

EXTRA WORDS 2 / 2 · ONLY IF YOU WANT MORE

20 extra words, easy to use

T
tangle
запутаться

S
slam
захлопнуть

J
jam
застрять

B
blush
краснеть

L
leak
протекать

G
giggle
хихикать

S
shatter
разбиться вдребезги

G
gasp
ахнуть

B
bounce
отскочить

S
sigh
вздохнуть

HOW IT WORKS · 1

when + past simple

I was crossing the street when a car stopped. ✓

Я переходил улицу, когда остановилась машина.

She was cooking when the lights went out. ✓

Она готовила, когда погас свет.

They were sleeping when the phone rang. ✓

Они спали, когда зазвонил телефон.

Long action (past continuous) + short event (past simple)

Длинное действие + короткое событие

when + the short event: when a car stopped

when + короткое событие

The short event interrupts the long action

Событие прерывает действие

HOW IT WORKS · 2

while + past continuous

While we were waiting, it started to rain. ✓

Пока мы ждали, начался дождь.

While he was driving, he dropped his phone. ✓

Пока он вёл машину, он уронил телефон.

I hurt my knee while I was playing soccer. ✓

Я повредил колено, когда играл в футбол.

while + the long action (past continuous)

while + длинное действие

Two long actions: While I was cooking, she was studying

Два длинных действия одновременно

Both orders are fine: While I was walking, I fell. · I fell while I was walking.

Оба порядка возможны

HOW IT WORKS · 3

The pattern of a story

It was a sunny day.	background: past continuous
A boy was riding his bike.	background: past continuous
Suddenly, a dog ran out.	event: past simple
He fell and hurt his knee.	event: past simple

Story words: suddenly, then, at that moment, luckily

Слова для рассказа

Past continuous = the scene · past simple = what happened

Past continuous — сцена, past simple — события

WATCH OUT

Four mistakes to avoid

I was crossing the street when a car was stopping. ✗
событие → past simple

→ I was crossing the street when a car stopped. ✓

While I walked, I saw an accident. ✗
while + past continuous

→ While I was walking, I saw an accident. ✓

She cooked when the lights went out. ✗
действие в процессе

→ She was cooking when the lights went out. ✓

He was breaking his arm while he was playing. ✗
событие → past simple

→ He broke his arm while he was playing. ✓

EXAMPLE SENTENCES

Look and say

I was crossing the street when a car stopped.
Я переходил улицу, когда остановилась машина.

While we were waiting, it started to rain.
Пока мы ждали, начался дождь.

She was running when she slipped on the ice.
Она бежала, когда поскользнулась на льду.

He dropped his phone while he was walking.
Он уронил телефон на ходу.

They were laughing when the teacher came in.
Они смеялись, когда вошёл учитель.

I realized it while I was talking to him.
Я понял это, пока разговаривал с ним.

We were driving home when we saw the accident.
Мы ехали домой, когда увидели аварию.

While I was cooking, my sister knocked over the milk.
Пока я готовил, сестра опрокинула молоко.

WORDS THAT GO TOGETHER

Collocations and phrasal verbs

5 COLLOCATIONS

in a hurry
в спешке

out of nowhere
откуда ни возьмись

just in time
как раз вовремя

on the way home
по дороге домой

at that moment
в тот момент

2 PHRASAL VERBS

bump into
случайно встретить

turn around
повернуться

Make one sentence with each of them. They are part of today's homework.

SPEAKING

Story chain

1. Sit in groups of 4. Student 1 starts the scene: It was Monday morning. I was walking to school…
2. Student 2 adds an event (past simple): Suddenly, I saw… / I dropped…
3. Student 3 says what was happening at the same time: While I was…, my friend was…
4. Student 4 ends the story. Go round twice; write down the story.

EXAMPLE

A. It was a sunny day. A boy was riding his bike.

B. Suddenly, a dog ran out of a yard.

C. While the boy was looking at the dog, he hit a tree.

D. Luckily, he wasn't hurt.

Scene = past continuous. What happened = past simple. Use: suddenly, then, at that moment, luckily.

PLAY TO PRACTICE

Games with a working link

Baamboozle: Past Continuous / Simple Past - When / While

https://www.baamboozle.com/game/1896161

Choose the right tense for each verb (When the post man arrived, my father was having a shower). Game code 1896161.

Baamboozle: Past simple, past continuous, when, while

https://www.baamboozle.com/game/1211546

Build the sentence from the verbs and WHEN or WHILE (While I was watching TV, the TV went off). Game code 1211546.

On the laptop: click the link, press **Play**, choose 2 to 4 teams. All pages were opened and checked on 31 Oct 2026.

LISTENING

Watch and listen

VOA Let's Learn English, Level 1, Lesson 39: It's Unbelievable!

https://learningenglish.voanews.com/a/lets-learn-english-lesson-39-its-unbelieveable/3598920.html

Video lesson with text and exercises.

Pick the one you like. First for the main idea, then again with the text.

LAST 5 MINUTES

Say it! Exit check

1. Say: I / walk / home / see an accident (when)
2. Say: she / cook / lights go out (when)
3. Say: we / wait / it start to rain (while)
4. Correct it: He was breaking his arm.
5. Elementary: What is the best place in your city?

Ask aloud, one student at a time. The answers are on the last page.

LAST 10 MINUTES

Speak! Recap with questions

1. What were you doing when the lesson started?
2. What was happening when you woke up today?
3. What did you see while you were walking to school?
4. Did anything funny happen while you were studying?
5. Where were you when you heard the last big news?
6. What were you doing when your phone rang today?
7. Did you ever hurt yourself while you were playing a sport?
8. What was your family doing when you came home yesterday?

Ask in pairs, then ask the whole class. Perfect sentences, please: stop and repeat if there is a mistake.

TEACHER · ANSWERS

Answer key · exercises

1 · Past simple or past continuous?

1. was walking, saw · 2. was cooking, went · 3. were sleeping, rang · 4. were waiting, started · 5. dropped, was walking · 6. hurt, was playing

2 · when or while?

1. while · 2. when · 3. While · 4. when · 5. while · 6. While

3 · Join the sentences

1. I was walking when I saw an accident. ·
2. While we were waiting, it started to rain. ·
3. She was cooking when the phone rang. ·
4. He fell while he was riding his bike. ·
5. They were sleeping when a noise woke them up.

4 · Find and correct the mistake

1. I was crossing the street when a car stopped. ·
2. While I was walking home, I saw an accident. ·
3. She was cooking when the lights went out. ·
4. He broke his arm while he was playing. ·
5. They were laughing when the teacher came in.

5 · Read and write T (true) or F (false)

1. T · 2. F · 3. F · 4. T · 5. T

6 · About you

Personal answers. Check: long action = past continuous, short event = past simple.

TEACHER · ANSWERS

Answer key · exit check and homework

EXIT CHECK

1. Say: I / walk / home / see an accident (when) → I was walking home when I saw an accident.
2. Say: she / cook / lights go out (when) → She was cooking when the lights went out.
3. Say: we / wait / it start to rain (while) → While we were waiting, it started to rain.
4. Correct it: He was breaking his arm. → He broke his arm.
5. Elementary: What is the best place in your city? → Personal answers.

RUSSIAN → ENGLISH

1. Я переходил улицу, когда остановилась машина. → I was crossing the street when a car stopped.
2. Пока мы ждали, начался дождь. → While we were waiting, it started to rain.
3. Она бежала, когда поскользнулась. → She was running when she slipped.
4. Он уронил телефон, пока шёл. → He dropped his phone while he was walking.
5. Они смеялись, когда вошёл учитель. → They were laughing when the teacher came in.
6. Мы ехали домой, когда увидели аварию. → We were driving home when we saw an accident.
7. Пока я готовил, сестра опрокинула молоко. → While I was cooking, my sister knocked over the milk.
8. Он повредил колено, пока играл в футбол. → He hurt his knee while he was playing soccer.
9. Я спал, когда зазвонил телефон. → I was sleeping when the phone rang.
10. К счастью, никто не пострадал. → Luckily, nobody was hurt.

TEACHER · ANSWERS

Answer key · weekly review

1 · Past continuous

1. was riding · 2. weren't watching · 3. Were, sleeping · 4. was, doing · 5. were waiting

2 · when or while: fill in

1. was walking, saw · 2. was cooking, went · 3. were waiting, started · 4. broke, was playing · 5. were laughing, came in

3 · Past simple

1. visited · 2. went · 3. didn't see · 4. Did · 5. was

4 · Present, comparing and the future

1. works · 2. is · 3. older · 4. going · 5. will

5 · Russian → English

1. I was crossing the street when a car stopped.
2. What were you doing when the lights went out?
3. While we were waiting, it started to rain.
4. They weren't sleeping when the phone rang.
5. Luckily, nobody was hurt.
6. Yesterday we went to the park, but we didn't buy anything.